Fennel and the Big Peach Shy

A story about feeling shy

by KUZU NOHA

Fennel and the Big Peach Shy

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For every little bear
with a big feeling.

Clover the bunny turned five today,

and Fennel was invited to come and play!

He wrapped up a gift in a bow of blue.

“A party!” said Mama. “I’ll go with you.”

Balloons! And music! And cake on a plate!

So many faces! Fennel stopped at the gate.

A fuzzy peach cloud
floated down, soft and slow.

It wrapped around Fennel from head to toe.

His voice went tiny. His cheeks felt hot.

He hid behind Mama and stayed on the spot.

Mama knelt down. “Shy is okay.

Lots of us feel shy, every day.”

“First, WAVE. Just lift your paw up high.

A wave is a way to say a shy hi.”

“Next, SAY one small hello.

‘Hi, I’m Fennel.’ Say it soft and slow.”

“Last, SHARE. Have something to give.

A toy or a snack helps a friendship live.”

Fennel waved a wave, and it wasn't so bad.

“Hi, I’m Fennel,” he said, feeling glad.

He shared his gift. Clover jumped with glee.

“Come play with me!” she said. “Come play with me!”

The peach cloud floated off like a feather.

Wave. Say. Share. Make friends together.

Fennel’s 3 Friendly Steps

1. WAVE

Lift a paw and wave hello.

2. SAY

Say one small hello.

3. SHARE

Share a toy or a snack.

Shy is okay.

Friends are waiting.

A Note for Grown-Ups

Name the feeling: “You feel shy.”

Do not push. Stay close until your child is ready.

Practice a wave and a hello at home.

Praise every small try.

Thank you for reading!

If Fennel helped your little one, a short review on Amazon helps other families find this book.